

EDUCATION ACCESS PROGRAM

VOLUNTEER CODE OF CONDUCT, CONFIDENTIALITY, AND PROGRAM BOUNDARY AGREEMENT

Version 1.0 | Effective Date: May 12, 2026

Document Title	Volunteer Code of Conduct, Confidentiality, and Program Boundary Agreement
Program	Education Access Program
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NOTICE. This document establishes internal standards of conduct for volunteers of the Education Access Program. It is intended for program governance, volunteer onboarding, and risk-management purposes. It does not constitute legal advice, does not create an attorney-client relationship, and should be reviewed by qualified counsel before being relied upon for jurisdiction-specific compliance obligations.

This Volunteer Code of Conduct, Confidentiality, and Program Boundary Agreement (the "Agreement") applies to each person who provides volunteer services, mentorship, tutoring, editing support, administrative assistance, outreach assistance, or any other support on behalf of the Education Access Program (the "Program"). By accepting a volunteer role or performing any Program-related service, the individual volunteer (the "Volunteer") agrees to comply with the obligations set forth below.

ARTICLE I. DEFINITIONS AND INTERPRETATION

1.1 Defined Terms. For purposes of this Agreement, the following terms shall have the meanings set forth below.

- (a) "Program" means the Education Access Program and any affiliated initiative, project, team, cohort, workshop, communication channel, volunteer group, or educational support activity operated under its name.
- (b) "Volunteer" means any person who provides unpaid support to the Program, including tutors, essay reviewers, application mentors, workshop facilitators, operations assistants, outreach volunteers, and student coordinators.
- (c) "Student" means any student, applicant, learner, family member, or participant receiving services from or communicating with the Program.
- (d) "Program Leadership" means the founder, director, designated coordinator, or other person authorized to supervise Program activities.
- (e) "Confidential Information" means any non-public information relating to a Student, family, Volunteer, partner organization, Program record, internal process, application material, educational background, location, contact information, personal history, or support request.
- (f) "Educational Support" means application planning, academic mentorship, essay feedback, SAT or English test preparation, scholarship research, resource navigation, workshops, and related educational assistance.

1.2 Construction. The headings in this Agreement are for organizational convenience only and shall not limit or modify the scope of any provision. The words "including," "includes," and similar terms shall be interpreted as non-exhaustive.

ARTICLE II. VOLUNTEER ROLE AND SCOPE OF SERVICES

2.1 Educational Role Only. The Volunteer shall provide Educational Support only. The Program is not a law office, immigration service provider, admissions agency, financial aid office, or government representative.

2.2 Permitted Support. Subject to Program policies and supervision, a Volunteer may assist with academic tutoring, essay feedback, school or scholarship research, application planning, workshop preparation, student mentorship, scheduling, tracking, and other approved educational support tasks.

2.3 No Agency Authority. The Volunteer shall not hold himself or herself out as having authority to bind the Program, speak on behalf of the Program in an official capacity, negotiate with institutions on behalf of Students, represent Students before third parties, or make commitments unless expressly authorized in writing by Program Leadership.

ARTICLE III. PROHIBITION ON LEGAL, VISA, ASYLUM, AND IMMIGRATION ADVICE

3.1 Absolute Prohibition. The Volunteer shall not provide legal, visa, asylum, immigration, border-entry, refugee-status, residency, work-authorization, travel-permission, or government-filing advice to any Student or family member.

3.2 Prohibited Conduct. Without limiting Section 3.1, the Volunteer shall not interpret legal requirements, advise on eligibility for a visa or immigration benefit, recommend legal strategies, complete legal forms, review immigration filings, collect immigration documents, advise whether a family should travel or relocate, or instruct a Student or family on legal steps to take.

3.3 Referral to Program Leadership. If a Student or family requests legal, visa, asylum, or immigration-related guidance, the Volunteer shall decline to answer and shall refer the matter to Program Leadership. Program Leadership may provide educational resources or direct the Student to qualified outside organizations, but Volunteers shall not attempt to resolve such matters independently.

ARTICLE IV. ACADEMIC INTEGRITY AND APPLICATION MATERIALS

4.1 No Ghostwriting. The Volunteer shall not write, ghostwrite, generate, fabricate, or substantially author any essay, personal statement, short-answer response, application response, scholarship essay, recommendation-related content, or other submission material for a Student.

4.2 Permitted Essay Support. The Volunteer may provide feedback regarding clarity, organization, grammar, structure, tone, specificity, authenticity, and overall presentation, provided that the final content remains the Student's own work and reflects the Student's own voice, judgment, and experience.

4.3 Misrepresentation Prohibited. The Volunteer shall not encourage, assist, or knowingly permit false, misleading, exaggerated, plagiarized, or fabricated statements in any application, essay, resume, activity list, scholarship submission, or related material.

4.4 Artificial Intelligence and External Tools. The Volunteer shall not use artificial intelligence tools, paid writing services, or other third-party drafting tools to produce submission-ready text for a Student unless expressly permitted by the relevant institution and approved by Program Leadership. When tools are used for brainstorming, grammar review, or instructional support, the Student remains responsible for the final content.

ARTICLE V. COMMUNICATIONS, BOUNDARIES, AND DIGITAL CONDUCT

5.1 Approved Purpose. All communications with Students shall be for Program-related Educational Support only. Volunteers shall maintain a professional, respectful, and appropriate tone in all emails, messages, calls, video meetings, shared documents, comments, and other communications.

5.2 Private Messaging and Direct Contact. Volunteers shall not initiate or continue inappropriate private direct messages with Students. Direct messages, if permitted by Program Leadership, must be limited to scheduling, educational support, and Program-approved communications.

5.3 Prohibited Communications. Volunteers shall not send romantic, sexual, threatening, harassing, discriminatory, insulting, coercive, manipulative, exploitative, excessively personal, or unrelated communications to any Student. Volunteers shall not pressure Students to respond outside reasonable hours or move communications to unapproved platforms.

5.4 Communications Involving Minors. When communicating with any Student under eighteen years of age, Volunteers shall comply with any additional safeguards established by the Program, including parent or guardian involvement, use of approved channels, group communications, meeting documentation, or other supervision requirements. Volunteers shall not engage in secret, personal, or unsupervised relationships with minors outside the Program scope.

5.5 No Personal Dependence. Volunteers shall not create relationships in which Students become personally dependent on a Volunteer for emotional support, financial support, housing, travel assistance, legal guidance, or crisis intervention. Volunteers shall refer concerns to Program Leadership when a Student's needs exceed the Volunteer's role.

ARTICLE VI. CONFIDENTIALITY AND INFORMATION PROTECTION

6.1 Confidentiality Obligation. The Volunteer shall protect and maintain the confidentiality of all Confidential Information obtained through Program activities. Confidential Information shall be used solely for approved Program purposes and shall not be disclosed except as authorized by Program Leadership or required by applicable law.

6.2 Restricted Disclosure. The Volunteer shall not disclose Confidential Information to friends, classmates, relatives, social media followers, outside organizations, other Students, or any person not authorized by the Program. The Volunteer shall not discuss identifiable Student circumstances outside Program channels.

6.3 Data Minimization. The Volunteer shall not request, collect, store, copy, upload, or retain unnecessary sensitive documents or personal information, including passports, immigration papers, government identification, medical records, financial documents, legal records, or detailed family safety information, unless expressly instructed by Program Leadership and consistent with Program policy.

6.4 Records and Program Systems. The Volunteer shall use Program-approved systems for records, session notes, document review, and communications when such systems are provided. The Volunteer shall not maintain independent records of Student information after the relationship ends unless authorized by Program Leadership.

6.5 Continuing Obligation. The duty of confidentiality survives the end of the Volunteer's relationship with the Program.

ARTICLE VII. RESPECT, NON-DISCRIMINATION, AND CULTURAL RESPONSIBILITY

7.1 Respectful Treatment. The Volunteer shall treat all Students, families, Volunteers, and partner organizations with dignity, patience, and respect. The Volunteer shall recognize that Students may have experienced displacement, conflict, interrupted education, trauma, economic hardship, language barriers, or other forms of instability.

7.2 Non-Discrimination. The Volunteer shall not discriminate, harass, stereotype, mock, exclude, or demean any person based on nationality, race, ethnicity, language, religion, sex, gender, disability, socioeconomic status, immigration background, political context, educational history, or any other personal characteristic.

7.3 No Assumptions or Exploitation of Background. The Volunteer shall not pressure Students to disclose personal, traumatic, political, family, or conflict-related experiences. Student stories shall not be used for publicity, fundraising, social media, presentations, or other external purposes without informed permission and Program Leadership approval.

ARTICLE VIII. NO GUARANTEES, PROMISES, OR MISLEADING STATEMENTS

8.1 No Guaranteed Outcomes. The Volunteer shall not promise, guarantee, imply, or represent that any Student will obtain admission, a scholarship, financial aid, a visa, relocation, test-score improvement, institutional acceptance, interview, employment opportunity, or any other outcome.

8.2 Accurate Representation. The Volunteer shall provide information honestly and within the limits of the Volunteer's knowledge. When uncertain, the Volunteer shall state that they are unsure and refer the issue to Program Leadership rather than guessing.

8.3 No Unauthorized Fees or Financial Arrangements. The Volunteer shall not request, accept, or solicit money, gifts, services, favors, or personal benefits from Students or families in connection with Program activities. The Volunteer shall not offer paid private services to Students met through the Program unless expressly approved in writing by Program Leadership.

ARTICLE IX. PROFESSIONALISM, RELIABILITY, AND PROGRAM RECORDS

9.1 Attendance and Preparedness. The Volunteer shall attend scheduled sessions on time, provide reasonable advance notice if unavailable, prepare for assigned responsibilities, and communicate clearly with Students and Program Leadership.

9.2 Session Documentation. The Volunteer shall complete any required session logs, progress notes, service-hour records, or outcome-tracking entries accurately and promptly. Program records shall be factual, respectful, and limited to information necessary for educational support.

9.3 Capacity and Withdrawal. If the Volunteer cannot continue a role, the Volunteer shall notify Program Leadership as early as practicable so that Students may be reassigned or supported without unnecessary disruption.

ARTICLE X. SAFETY, ESCALATION, AND REPORTING

10.1 Duty to Escalate. If a Student communicates information that suggests imminent danger, exploitation, abuse, harassment, self-harm, severe distress, inappropriate communication, or any situation outside the Volunteer's role, the Volunteer shall promptly notify Program Leadership and shall not attempt to investigate, counsel, or resolve the matter independently.

10.2 Boundary Concerns. The Volunteer shall report any request for legal or immigration advice, request for money, request for sensitive documents, unusual communication from a Student or adult, suspected confidentiality breach, discrimination concern, or other conduct that may violate this Agreement.

10.3 Good-Faith Reporting. Volunteers who report concerns in good faith shall not be penalized by the Program for making such reports. Reports shall be handled with appropriate discretion and seriousness.

ARTICLE XI. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY, PUBLICITY, AND EXTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS

11.1 Program Materials. Training materials, templates, intake forms, tracking systems, workshop materials, and other Program-created resources shall be used for Program purposes unless Program Leadership authorizes other use.

11.2 Public Statements. The Volunteer shall not post, publish, present, or speak publicly on behalf of the Program without authorization. The Volunteer shall not use Student stories, screenshots, names, photos, essays, messages, or identifiable details in any public or semi-public forum without explicit Program approval and appropriate consent.

ARTICLE XII. COMPLIANCE, CORRECTIVE ACTION, AND REMOVAL

12.1 Compliance Obligation. Compliance with this Agreement is a condition of volunteer participation. The Program may require additional training, supervision, documentation, or safeguards at any time.

12.2 Corrective Action. A violation of this Agreement may result in coaching, warning, reassignment, suspension, removal from Student contact, termination of volunteer participation, or other action deemed appropriate by Program Leadership.

12.3 Immediate Removal. The Program may immediately remove a Volunteer from any role for serious misconduct, including inappropriate communications, confidentiality breaches, discrimination or harassment, unauthorized legal or immigration advice, ghostwriting, misuse of Student information, or conduct that compromises Student safety or Program integrity.

12.4 No Employment Relationship. Nothing in this Agreement creates an employment relationship, partnership, agency relationship, entitlement to compensation, or guaranteed volunteer placement. Volunteer participation may be ended by either the Volunteer or the Program at any time.

ARTICLE XIII. VOLUNTEER ACKNOWLEDGMENT AND AGREEMENT

13.1 Acknowledgment. By signing below, the Volunteer acknowledges that the Volunteer has read, understands, and agrees to comply with this Agreement. The Volunteer further acknowledges that failure to comply may result in removal from the Program.

13.2 Certification. The Volunteer certifies that all Program communications, services, and interactions will be conducted in accordance with the boundaries described in this Agreement and any additional policies issued by Program Leadership.

SIGNATURE PAGE

By signing this page, the undersigned Volunteer agrees to be bound by the Education Access Program Volunteer Code of Conduct, Confidentiality, and Program Boundary Agreement, Version 1.0, effective May 12, 2026.

_____ Volunteer Full Legal Name

_____ Volunteer Signature

_____ Date

_____ Email Address

_____ School / Institution

Program Use Only

_____ Received By

_____ Program Role / Title

_____ Date Received